

Two Days, A Million Podcasts

Apple's new iTunes is going great guns. The company recently said people have already subscribed to more than 1 million Podcasts through the new version of its iTunes software, released July 5. In a speech to developers in early July, Steve Jobs called Podcasting "the hottest thing going in radio".



Online-only Brands 'Lack Trust'

Online shopping just turned 10. But nearly two out of three consumers prefer to buy a known and trusted brand that also exists offline, a new study claims. A survey of over 1,000 customers by insurers Direct Line shows shoppers still do not trust online-only brands.



Escape

CHANGING ONLINE HABITS

The Threat Is Real

According to a survey of US Net users from the Pew Internet and American Life Project, the threat of spyware and other unwanted programs is changing the way people use the Net. Nine out of 10 users said they had "adjusted their online behaviour" due to the threat of malware.

A quarter of users have spotted new programs or desktop icons on their PCs that they hadn't installed. One in five users (18 per cent) has had their homepage inexplicably changed. Both these are common signs of malware infection. Of those polled, 68 per cent have experienced problems with their PCs over the last year, problems that seem to be indicative of either spyware or viral infection, although 60 per cent of those who had problems weren't sure of the cause of their difficulties.

The survey has several other interesting findings to offer: 81 per cent of users said they stopped opening unsolicited e-mail attachments (finally!)



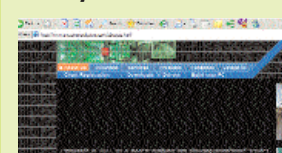
48 per cent said they stopped visiting untrustworthy Web sites out of spyware concerns. A fourth of those polled even said they had stopped downloading music or video

files from P2P networks in order to avoid unwittingly downloading unwanted programs. And a minority of surfers—18 per cent—said they changed their Web browser in order to avoid malware attacks.

There's another perspective to this: Net users are changing their surfing habits, but it's not perhaps due to security advice from vendors. As an example of this, only one in three Windows XP users in the US have applied Service Pack 2, which promises improved defences against hacking and computer virus attacks. "We know that the percentage of people using Windows XP SP 2 is lower than we would like it to be. One in three machines that run Windows XP is running SP 2. Customers are still reluctant to upgrade," Mario Juarez, a security product manager at Microsoft is reported to have admitted.

UNUSABLE!

www.systemsnsolutions.com



Systems and Solutions is an "A to Z Computer Store"—at least that's what it says on their Web site. However, after navigating through it, one realises that the meaning of either the term 'A to Z' or 'Computer Store' needs to be redefined.

Surfing this site gives you the feel of a newly constructed building with a neat external appearance but an incomplete and raw interior. The design and layout look professional, but hardly any of the links actually function.

Under the 'Products' section appears a Flash-animated picture of a desktop with the usual peripherals. The idea is to display a catalogue, but none of the links work. If you click on the 'Speakers' picture in this image, all you get is a window with the word 'Speakers' in bold.

The same goes for the rest of the links and sections. The section titled 'Build Your PC' inspires interest, but does nothing at all. A blank page comes up when you click it. Some indication like "coming soon" would have been appreciated.

'Feedback' and 'Client Registration' use the general principle of the page of displaying nothing.

The saving grace is the 'Contact Us' link, which does what it should—show the contact details of the owners.

Win! My Desktop

Think you have the most beautiful, most innovative desktop around? e-mail with subject '**My Desktop**' and your postal address to mydesktop@thinkdigit.com, and Digit will publish the most eye-catching of them each month.

The winner receives a copy of **Fundamentals of Digital Image Processing** by Anil K Jain published by Pearson Education (Singapore) Pte. Ltd



Charan's desktop spews fire all the way.
Sent in by Charan Reddy (cres_charan@rediffmail.com)